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ELECTION 2026

A NEW BLUE ERA

Across nation: Staggering results, historic surprises reshape power in Washington

In Illinois: Voters prove state's deep Democratic bona fides as Pritzker, Stratton roll

In Chicago: Biggs' school board president win delivers blow to CTU, City Hall allies



School board President-elect Jessica Biggs appears at her election night party at RPM Events in Chicago's River North neighborhood on Tuesday. E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

SCHOOL BOARD

Facing split panel, mayor plants flag against closures

By Alice Yin and Kate Armanini
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor Brandon Johnson on Wednesday heralded the long-awaited advent of Chicago's first-ever elected school board before delivering an unequivocal warning should the new body try to close any schools.

"I can promise you this: the city of Chicago will make a considerable amount of noise if they're proposing to close schools," Johnson said in an interview with the Tribune. "I took an arrest standing up for our neighborhood schools and went on a hunger strike. ... There's a long legacy of people standing up against corporate control over our schools, so I fully anticipate that voices will continue to rise up."

The mayor and former Chicago Teachers Union organizer said he plans to speak with all members of the school board, including

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SCHOOL BOARD

Biggs promises to forge ahead with focus on students

By Alice Yin, Kate Armanini, Kate Perez and Darcel Rockett
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Former South Side principal Jessica Biggs won the city's first election for school board president Tuesday, a major blow to the Chicago Teachers Union and its ally Mayor Brandon Johnson.

Early returns showed Biggs leading 48.6% to runner-up Hilario Dominguez's 30.9% share, with 96% of precincts counted, according to the Chicago Board of Elections. Victor Henderson trailed behind at 17.8%.

In a 20-minute interview with the Tribune on Wednesday, Biggs vowed to forge ahead with a new era of student-focused stewardship over the nation's third-largest school district. She also opined on why she triumphed over Dominguez, most recently the Chicago Teachers Union deputy political director.

See BIGGS on Page A3



Gov. JB Pritzker and Lt. Gov.-elect Christian Mitchell arrive to thank voters on Wednesday at Peach's in Chicago's Bronzeville neighborhood. BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

GOVERNOR

Pritzker turns eyes toward Washington, with 'bold agenda' for victorious Dems

By Rick Pearson
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

JB Pritzker's decisive victory over Republican Darren Bailey and Democrats gaining control of both chambers in Congress have set the stage for Illinois' third-term chief executive to pursue a potential bid for the party's White House nomination in 2028.

A day after voting on Tuesday sent a resounding blue wave across the country and through Illinois, Pritzker was already looking to expand from Springfield to Washington, releasing a 200-item playbook calling on Democrats in Congress to act with "urgency and conviction" on a "bold agenda."

Saying the Trump administration "has spit in the faces of working families," Pritzker urged Democrats to immediately begin work to increase

See PRITZKER on Page A9

CONGRESS

Midterm blowout 'stunning rebuke' of Trump agenda

By Lisa Mascaro
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The midterm election blowout delivered a new era in Washington, with Democrats in Congress eager to meet voter demands for change while Republicans watched their majorities evaporate after a revolt against President Donald Trump and his party in power.

Democrats ousted Republicans from coast to coast, with many surprising places in between, in a decisive rejection of unified GOP control for the promise of something different for the country. Their majorities will be padded by unusually wide margins in both the House and the Senate.

The staggering results are setting up a starkly divided government, with an emboldened Congress poised to assert itself as a co-equal branch when Democrats take over in the new year. They

See BLOWOUT on Page A8

Stratton quickly gets to work

After winning Illinois' open Senate seat, Lt. Gov. Juliana Stratton on Wednesday embraced Gov. JB Pritzker's lengthy Democratic agenda. **Chicagoland, Page A2**

A split verdict for CTU agenda

Chicago's first-ever full school board election delivered mixed results for the teachers union that fought for the elected board's existence. **Chicagoland, Page A3**

Vance seeks distance from war

Vice President JD Vance publicly broke from President Donald Trump's defense of the Iran war on Wednesday after GOP's election losses. **Nation & World, Page B4**

EIGHT FULL PAGES OF CHICAGOLAND MIDTERM ELECTION COVERAGE INSIDE TODAY'S PAPER

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TODAY	FRI.	SAT.
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